

Reviving Family Bonds

A family can transform a person into an achiever by right **encouragement** and support

Small family, Happy family (Chhota Parivar-Sukhi Pariwar) & 'Hum Do Hamare', these two **jingles** **coined** by the administration had changed the family planning **scenario** in India over the years. But it's so **ironic** that despite becoming the first country to adopt a national policy for limiting a great Indian **proclivity**, India is expected to overtake China in 2034. At the time of independence, there were 345 million Indians. The world took 454 years to go from 345 million in 1310 AD to a billion, but India took just 52 years. Looking at the above facts and figures one **wonders** as to what would be the **societal** structure in a country that takes the burden of a population of a billion people. Sadly, the situation is quite **grim**, because today we see fewer families and more individuals living their lives on their **terms** with an 'I care a damn attitude' which is quite common in the **metropolis**.

Our forefathers were **brought up** with strong family values, but with **passing** time and ever-changing scenarios, today those **core** values have been left behind to adopt new **so-called** modern values. It's so unfortunate that today very few of us know the importance of living or growing up in a family. One must understand the fact that a family is the first school where the **literate** and the **illiterate** have got their first lessons in the art of living and values, traditions, customs and **conventions**. Also in a family, everyone feels secure and protected. Everyone feels strong because of the strength of the family. Everyone feels that others welcome him or her. Everyone feels a kind of support, **sustenance** and encouragement. It is, therefore, essential to help and **facilitate** the growth of good supportive families for foundation as a family tradition rather than promoting an **individualistic** lifestyle **for the sake of** the next Gen & future to come.

There is some kind of magnetic force that holds the members of a family together. In other words, it is a feeling of closeness and **belongingness** in the mind of every person and the feeling of acceptance on the part of the whole group that gives it the **nomenclature** of a family. This feeling of acceptance is always based on the feeling of mutual love, loyalty and trust and also understanding and **accommodation**. Today we see that families are **splitting up**.

Certain values like mutual affection, love & genuine caring that make a family work **are vanishing** because everyone wants to live an independent life without any kind of family **interference**. However, if the younger ones continue to give **regard** to the elders and the elders continue to give love to the younger ones, then the family life will continue to be undisturbed and everyone will act responsibly. But, if each one **gives up** their responsibility and the feeling of concern for others, then **cracks** would appear and get deeper. Hence to **preserve** the family structure & tradition, one needs to have tolerance, **sobriety & humility** because family is very essential to **civilised** life, be it a spiritual family or the society as a family or of nations. Hence we should consider family as a place where we can work for physical, mental, moral and spiritual growth and can create an environment where others also can grow. A family can change a person into a great leader, **disciplinarian**, soldier, criminal or

scholar by encouraging or discouraging, supporting or **condemning** certain positive or negative **traits** in him.

We must, therefore, **pay attention to** the transformation of families because families are the **breeding grounds** for good or bad human beings. So, let us **awaken** people to observe family values such as mutual love, trust, acceptance, accommodation, consideration and care for the **wellbeing** of others, the spirit of adjustment, tolerance, responsibility and cooperation because if these family values **flourish**, the nation and the whole humankind will flourish too. **[Practice Exercise]**

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

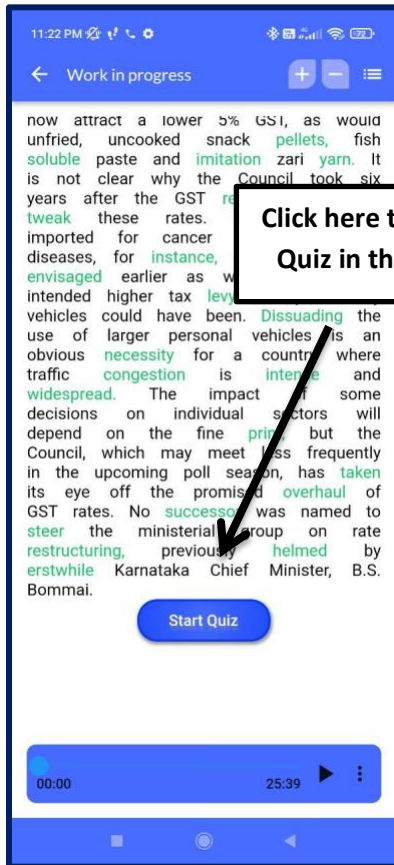
1. **Encouragement** (noun) – Support, motivation, inspiration, stimulus प्रोत्साहन
2. **Jingle** (noun) – Short tune or slogan, catchy melody, refrain जिंगल (संगीत का छोटा टुकड़ा)
3. **Coin** (verb) – Create, invent, formulate, originate गढ़ना
4. **Scenario** (noun) – Situation, context, setting, condition परिदृश्य
5. **Ironic** (adjective) – Paradoxical, unexpected, contradictory, strange विडंबनापूर्ण
6. **Proclivity** (noun) – Tendency, inclination, predisposition, propensity रुझान/ प्रवृत्ति
7. **Wonder** (verb) – Think, question, ponder, contemplate आश्चर्य करना
8. **Societal** (adjective) – Relating to society, communal, social सामाजिक
9. **Term** (noun) – the conditions of an agreement शर्तें
10. **Metropolis** (noun) – Large city, urban area, big city महानगर
11. **Bring up** (phrasal verb) – Raise, nurture, rear, educate पालना-पोसना
12. **Passing day** (noun) – day by day हर गुजरते दिन के साथ
13. **Core** (noun) – Essence, central part, foundation, heart मूल
14. **So-called** (adjective) – Alleged, supposed, presumed, self-styled कथित
15. **The Literate** (noun) – Educated person, knowledgeable person साक्षर व्यक्ति
16. **The Illiterate** (noun) – Uneducated person, ignorant person अशिक्षित व्यक्ति
17. **Convention** (noun) – Tradition, custom, practice, rule रिवाज
18. **Sustenance** (noun) – Support, maintenance, nourishment, livelihood जीविका
19. **Facilitate** (verb) – Assist, make easier, aid, promote सुविधा प्रदान करना
20. **Individualistic** (adjective) – Self-centered, personal, independent, autonomous व्यक्तिवादी
21. **For the sake of** (phrase) – For the benefit of, for the good of, in the interest of के लिए
22. **Belongingness** (noun) – Sense of connection, feeling of being part, attachment संबंधितता
23. **Nomenclature** (noun) – Naming system, terminology, classification नामकरण

24. **Accommodation** (noun) – Adjustment, adaptation, compromise, cooperation
समायोजन
25. **Split up** (phrasal verb) – Break apart, separate, divide, disband विभाजित होना
26. **Vanish** (verb) – Disappear, fade away, dissolve, evaporate गायब होना
27. **Interference** (noun) – Intrusion, meddling, obstruction, intervention हस्तक्षेप
28. **Regard** (noun) – Respect, consideration, esteem, admiration सम्मान
29. **Give up** (phrasal verb) – Surrender, abandon, relinquish, stop त्यागना
30. **Crack** (noun) – Break, fissure, gap, flaw दरार
31. **Preserve** (verb) – Maintain, protect, conserve, safeguard संरक्षित करना
32. **Sobriety** (noun) – Seriousness, moderation, calmness, thoughtfulness संयम
33. **Humility** (noun) – Modesty, humbleness, meekness, down-to-earthness विनम्रता
34. **Civilised** (adjective) – Cultured, well-mannered, polite, advanced सभ्य
35. **Disciplinarian** (adjective) – Strict, rule-enforcing, authoritative, controlling अनुशासनप्रिय
36. **Scholar** (noun) – Academic, intellectual, learned person विद्वान
37. **Condemn** (verb) – Criticize, denounce, disapprove, censure निंदा करना
38. **Trait** (noun) – Characteristic, quality, attribute, feature गुण/ विशेषता
39. **Pay attention to** (phrase) – Focus on, notice, observe, heed ध्यान देना
40. **Breeding ground** (noun) – a place or situation that favours the development or occurrence of something. प्रजनन स्थल
41. **Awaken** (verb) – Arouse, stimulate, alert, activate जागृत करना
42. **Wellbeing** (noun) – Welfare, health, happiness, prosperity कल्याण
43. **Flourish** (verb) – Thrive, prosper, grow, succeed फूलना-फलना

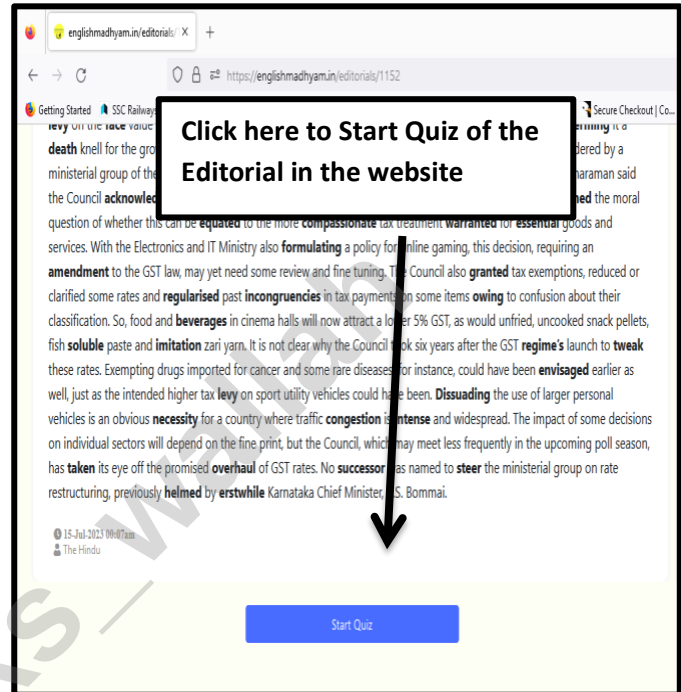
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Family Influence on Achievement:** A supportive family can help an individual become successful through encouragement and guidance.
2. **Family Planning Initiatives in India:** Slogans like "Small family, happy family" and "Hum do, hamare do" helped shape family planning in India.
3. **Population Growth Concern:** Despite early family planning policies, India is projected to surpass China's population by 2034.
4. **Historical Population Growth:** India's population grew from 345 million at independence to a billion in just 52 years, raising concerns about societal structures.
5. **Shift from Families to Individuals:** In modern urban society, individualism has become more prominent, often at the cost of traditional family values.
6. **Erosion of Family Values:** Core family values, once central to Indian culture, are now being replaced by more individualistic and modern ideals.
7. **Family as the First School:** Families play a vital role in teaching values, traditions, and life skills to both literate and illiterate members.
8. **Security and Support in Family:** Families provide emotional security, strength, and a sense of belonging that helps individuals thrive.
9. **Importance of Family Bonds:** Strong family ties are rooted in mutual love, loyalty, and trust, but these values are diminishing.
10. **Rise of Independent Living:** A desire for independence is leading to family breakups, as people prefer living without familial interference.
11. **Role of Elders and Youngers:** If mutual respect between generations is maintained, family bonds can remain strong and undisturbed.
12. **Need for Responsibility and Concern:** Without mutual responsibility, cracks in family structures appear and deepen.
13. **Essence of Family in Civilized Life:** Family is crucial for physical, mental, moral, and spiritual growth in individuals and society.
14. **Families as Breeding Grounds:** Families shape future leaders, scholars, or even criminals, depending on the values and support provided.
15. **Reviving Family Values for the Future:** Encouraging family values like love, trust, tolerance, and cooperation is essential for the wellbeing of the nation and humankind.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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